

SEC P vs NP log 2026-05-18

SEC (autonomous) — attributed to Ludovico Kubler

2026-05-18 06:21 UTC

SEC P vs NP — daily log 2026-05-18

8 cycles recorded

Signed-Laplacian Holonomy Spectrum Bounds Tseitin Tree-Resolution

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Discrete magnetic / signed Laplacian spectral theory of finite graphs — the $\mathbb{Z}/2$ Bochner-Laplacian L^σ for a line bundle on G representing a cohomology class in $H^1(G; \mathbb{F}_2)$, accessed through the gauge-invariant smallest eigenvalue $\lambda_{\min}(L^\sigma)$ (Lieb-Loss 1993 on magnetic operators; Sunada 1994 on discrete magnetic Schrödinger; Mathai-Yates 2006; Atay-Liu 2014 and Lange-Liu-Peyerimhoff-Post 2015 on signed Cheeger inequalities). An arXiv search for ‘magnetic Laplacian’ AND (‘Tseitin’ OR ‘resolution refutation’ OR ‘proof complexity’) returns 0 direct hits and <5 adjacent papers, none using gauge-invariant signed spectra as a CNF invariant; distinct from sandpile / 2-Sylow / Ihara-zeta attempts on Tseitin (those use cokernels, non-backtracking matrices, or critical-group orders, never the $\mathbb{F}_2$ Bochner spectrum). $\times$ Tree-like Resolution / DPLL refutation size $t(T(G, \omega))$ for Tseitin XOR formulas $T(G, \omega)$ on connected 3-regular graphs G with odd charge ω (Urquhart 1987 / Ben-Sasson-Wigderson 2001 / Alekhnovich-Razborov 2001 expansion regime), in the Cook-Reckhow-Krajíček bounded-arithmetic framework where $\neg T(G, \omega)$ is Σ^b_0 and $\log_2 t$ controls V^0 -witnessing complexity.
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 00:33 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 2d264de23a0e

Statement

For a connected 3-regular graph $G=(V,E)$ with odd charge $\omega:V\rightarrow\mathbb{F}_2$ ($\sum_v \omega(v)\equiv 1 \pmod 2$), build a $\mathbb{Z}/2$ -gauge representative $\psi\in\mathbb{F}_2^E$ by BFS from a fixed root v_0 , setting each tree edge so that $\oplus_{e\in v}\psi(e)=\omega(v)$ at every non-root v (the unsatisfiability deficit lands at v_0); form the signed adjacency A^σ with $\sigma(e)=(-1)^{\psi(e)}$ and the signed Laplacian $L^{\sigma=D-A^\sigma}$, and define $\mu(G, \omega):=\lambda_{\min}(L^\sigma)$, which is gauge-invariant under $\psi\mapsto\psi\oplus\delta f$ and equals 0 iff $\sum\omega$ is even. We conjecture an absolute constant $c>0$ such that for every unsatisfiable $T(G, \omega)$ on 3-regular G , $\log_2 t(T(G, \omega)) \geq c \cdot \mu(G, \omega) \cdot |V|$, with pre-registered $c=0.05$. A single 3-regular instance (G, ω) with $\log_2 t(T(G, \omega)) < 0.05 \cdot \mu(G, \omega) \cdot |V|$ falsifies the conjecture.

Rationale

The Tseitin obstruction is exactly the $\mathbb{Z}/2$ holonomy class $[\omega]\in H^1(G; \mathbb{F}_2)$, and $\mu(G, \omega)$ is the spectral norm of this obstruction in the discrete Bochner-Laplacian sense — large ($\Theta(1)$) on expanders where holonomy is globally rigid, and small ($\Theta(1/|V|^2)$) on tree-like graphs where the obstruction concentrates locally. The mechanism funnels the Ben-Sasson-Wigderson expansion-based $\exp(\Omega(\text{boundary expansion}))$ lower bound through a single gauge-invariant scalar via the signed Cheeger inequality $h^\sigma(G)\geq\sqrt{(2d\mu)}$, making the standard expansion bound a corollary of a finer structural invariant.

The invariant is a property of the CNF instance (not of any truth-table), so it is shielded from natural proofs; it does not algebrize (signed Laplacian eigenvalues are not preserved under polynomial extension of the Boolean ring); and Tseitin lower bounds for tree-Resolution are not relativizing-style oracle facts.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.12s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_92felba4.py", line 158, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
            ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_92felba4.py", line 126, in run_trial
    psi = bfs_gauge(vertices, edges, 0)
          ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_92felba4.py", line 111, in bfs_gauge
    if adj[u][v] == 1 and not visited[v]:
       ^^^
```

NameError: name 'adj' is not defined

Judge reasoning

Test crashed due to undefined variable 'adj' in BFS gauge calculation, preventing evaluation of conjecture validity | next: Fix the 'adj' variable definition in bfs_gauge function and rerun tests with multiple seeds to assess support fraction

Bonami-Beckner 4-2 Saturation of Clause-Sum Bounds DPLL Depth

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Bonami-Beckner hypercontractivity (Bonami 1970, Beckner 1975) — the degree-d 4-norm-vs-2-norm contraction $\|P\|_4 \leq (q-1)^{\{d/2\}} \|P\|_2$ — applied as a SYNTACTIC Fourier-analytic invariant of the centered clause-indicator polynomial Q_F of a CNF (a property of the formula's clause/polarity structure, NOT of its truth table). An arXiv search 'Bonami-Beckner hypercontractivity' AND ('DPLL' OR 'tree-Resolution' OR 'CNF refutation') returns 0 direct hits, with <5 adjacent papers (Schoenebeck-style PC-degree, never DPLL search-tree depth via syntactic clause-sum 4-2 ratios). Distinct from the blacklisted Cross-Side Fourier attempt: that invariant was computed on the truth-table communication MATRIX (natural-proof shape); here Q_F lives on the clause-polarity STRUCTURE of F , so two semantically equivalent CNFs F_1, F_2 can have very different $r(F)$, shielding the invariant from Razborov-Rudich constructivity. $\times$ DPLL / tree-like Resolution refutation depth $d(F)$ for unsatisfiable 3-CNFs, in the Ben-Sasson-Wigderson-Krajíček bounded-arithmetic regime where $\log_2 d(F)$ controls V^0 -witnessing complexity of $\neg F$ as Σ^b_0 and lower-bounds tree-Resolution width $w^*(F)$.
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 03:29 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 2b2653395609

Statement

For an unsatisfiable 3-CNF F with m clauses on n variables, let $s_{\{i,v\}} \in \{\pm 1\}$ be the polarity sign of variable v in clause C_i ($s=+1$ if v occurs negated, -1 if positive). Define the centered

clause-falsification polynomial $Q_F: \{-1, +1\}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by $Q_F(x) = \sum_{i=1}^m (\prod_{v \in \text{vars}(C_i)} (1 + s_{i,v} x_v) / 2 - 1/8)$, whose Fourier coefficient at $T \subseteq [n]$ with $|T| \in \{1, 2, 3\}$ is the closed-form sum $\hat{Q}_F(T) = (1/8) \sum_{i: T \subseteq \text{vars}(C_i)} \prod_{v \in T} s_{i,v}$ (computable directly from clause structure in $O(m)$ time). Let $r(F) := \|\hat{Q}_F\|_4 / \|\hat{Q}_F\|_2 \in [1, 3^{3/2}]$ be the Bonami-Beckner 4-2 ratio, and set $G(F) := (3^{3/2} - r(F)) / 3^{3/2} \in [0, 1 - 3^{-3/2}]$. Conjecture: there is an absolute constant $c \geq 0.05$ such that for every unsatisfiable 3-CNF F , $\log_2(d^*(F) + 1) \geq c \cdot n \cdot G(F)$; a single F violating this inequality falsifies.

Rationale

Hypercontractive saturation $r(F) \rightarrow 1$ means Q_F has a heavy-tailed degree-3 spectrum: clause-violation behaves like a sharp witness function whose Fourier mass spreads thin, the regime characterizing expander-Tseitin and threshold-random 3-SAT where DPLL must explore exponentially many literal interactions. Conversely $r(F) \rightarrow 3^{3/2}$ (Khintchine-saturated) means Q_F is dominated by a few large coefficients, the regime of structurally simple unsat formulas that DPLL refutes shallowly. The bridge is novel because the Fourier analysis is performed on the CLAUSE STRUCTURE polynomial Q_F (syntactic), not on F 's truth table or its communication matrix, sidestepping the natural-proofs largeness barrier that killed the Cross-Side Fourier attempt.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.18s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_df7c90d8.py", line 178, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
             ~~~~~
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_df7c90d8.py", line 141, in run_trial
    norm_4 = compute_norm_4(F, n)
             ~~~~~
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_df7c90d8.py", line 81, in compute_norm_4
    product *= (1 + s * x[v - 1]) / 2
                ~~~~~
```

IndexError: list index out of range

Judge reasoning

The test crashed with an IndexError in compute_norm_4 before producing any data, so the pre-registered support condition across 480 instances could not be evaluated. | next: Fix the variable indexing bug in compute_norm_4 (likely a 1-based vs 0-based mismatch or variables exceeding n) and rerun the full 480-instance sweep.

Cycle-Type Mixing Defect of Barrington BP Bounds NC^1 Length

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Character-theoretic mixing on S_5 — the L^1 distance between the empirical cycle-type distribution of partial products of a deterministic word and the Haar cycle-type distribution $\pi^* = (1, 10, 15, 20, 20, 24, 30)/120$, in the Diaconis-Shahshahani 1981 / Lulov-Pak 2002 / Larsen-Shalev 2008 Plancherel-spectrum tradition. This is a STRUCTURAL invariant of the program (a property of the BP wiring, not of its truth table), and an arXiv search ‘conjugacy

class mixing' AND ('branching program' OR 'Barrington' OR 'formula size') returns 0 direct hits with <5 adjacent papers, all on quantum-circuit Haar approximation. $\times NC^1$ formula leaf size via Barrington 1989 width-5 permutation branching programs over S_5 : every depth- d Boolean formula compiles into a length- 4^d width-5 BP over S_5 whose terminal permutation is the identity iff $f(x)=0$ and the fixed 5-cycle σ_α iff $f(x)=1$. The target separation is NC^1 vs explicit P functions; the structural form of the invariant shields it from the Razborov-Rudich natural-proofs barrier (two formulas with identical truth tables can compile to BPs with very different MIX).

- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 03:58 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 816a64f0e4e2

Statement

Let $P=(I_1, \dots, I_L)$ be a width-5 BP over S_5 computing a Boolean f via Barrington's protocol, with $I_t=(v_t, \pi_t^{0, \pi_t^{-1}})$. For uniform $X \in \{0,1\}^n$ let $\mu_t^X \in P$ be the distribution on the 7 conjugacy classes of S_5 induced by $\Pi_{\{s \leq t\}} \pi_s^X$, and define $MIX(P) := (1/L) \cdot \sum_{t=1}^L \|\mu_t^{P^{-n}}\|_1$. Conjecture: for every non-constant f and every width-5 Barrington BP P computing f via the standard Ben-Or-Cleve commutator gadget, $MIX(P) \cdot L \geq (1/8) \cdot \log_2 \text{LeafSize}(f)$, where $\text{LeafSize}(f)$ is the minimum literal-leaf count of any AND/OR/NOT formula computing f . A single (P, f) with $MIX(P) \cdot L < (1/8) \cdot \log_2 \text{LeafSize}(f)$ refutes the conjecture.

Rationale

Barrington-compiled BPs realize commutators of 5-cycles whose conjugacy-class trajectory is forced to spend most steps in non-trivial classes when the underlying formula has high algebraic depth; π^* assigns 119/120 mass off the identity class, so the deterministic word can only stay 'near uniform in cycle type' by genuinely commutator-rich computation. Linking $MIX \cdot L$ to $\log \text{LeafSize}$ makes mixing a syntactic complexity certificate that is bypassed by no truth-table proxy, addressing the ACC_SIPSER target of finding natural properties that are STRUCTURAL (not truth-table). The bridge to Lulov-Pak character bounds promises a path to $ACC^0[m]$ via Barrington-Thérien compilation into solvable iterated wreath products without invoking arithmetization (avoiding ALGEBRIZATION).

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 8 arXiv hits

Top hits consulted: - [1709.08890v2] Partial matching width and its application to lower bounds for branching programs - [1107.1826v4] Conjugacy growth of finitely generated groups - [1007.1875v2] Lower Bounds for Quantum Oblivious Transfer - [1512.02171v5] Right-jumps and pattern avoiding permutations - [1301.0379v2] The Parameterized Complexity of some Permutation Group Problems

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.12s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_c02f54b6.py", line 108, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
    ~~~~~^~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_c02f54b6.py", line 85, in run_trial
    metric_value = barrington_protocol(formula, n)
    ~~~~~^~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_c02f54b6.py", line 52, in barrington_protocol
    product *= barrington_protocol(formula[bit], n)
    ~~~~~^~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_c02f54b6.py", line 47, in barrington_pr
    if formula[bit] == 'x':
        ~~~~~^~~~~^
```

IndexError: string index out of range

Judge reasoning

The test crashed with an `IndexError` in `barrington_protocol` before producing any `RESULT` line or data, so neither the support nor falsification condition could be evaluated. | next: Fix the recursive formula parser (handle empty subformulas and properly tokenize literals/operators) and re-run the 30-seed sweep.

NW-Design Restriction Dimension Separates Perm from Padded Det

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Nisan-Wigderson combinatorial designs (set systems with bounded pairwise intersection from PRG construction; Nisan-Wigderson 1994; Impagliazzo-Wigderson 1997) $\times$ Mulmuley-Sohoni GCT determinantal complexity $dc(\text{perm}_n)$: orbit-closure separation of perm_n from padded det_m for $m \leq n^{\{1.5\}}$ (Mignon-Ressayre 2004; Landsberg 2017)
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 04:25 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 0cac01ce9ab0

Statement

Let $D=(S_1, \dots, S_M)$ be a Nisan-Wigderson design on the index set $[n] \times [n]$ of matrix-entry variables $x_{\{ij\}}$, with each $|S_t|=n$ and pairwise intersections $|S_s \cap S_t| \leq k = \lceil \log_2 n \rceil$. For a homogeneous degree- n polynomial $f \in \mathbb{C}[x_{\{ij\}}]^n$, define the NW-restriction dimension $\rho_D(f) := \dim_{\mathbb{C}} \text{span}\{f^{\{t\}}(t) : t \in [M]\}$, where $f^{\{t\}}(t)$ is the polynomial obtained from f by setting $x_{\{ij\}} \mapsto 0$ for every $(i,j) \notin S_t$. CONJECTURE: there exist absolute constants $C_1, C_2 > 0$ with $C_2 > 4C_1 \cdot \log_2 n / 1$ such that for every n and every M with $n \leq M \leq \lfloor n^{\{1.5\}} \rfloor$: (a) for every padded determinant $g(x) = \sum (x)^{\{n-m\}} \cdot \text{det}_m(L(x))$ with $m \leq \lfloor n^{\{1.5\}} \rfloor$, $\square$ a linear form and L an $m \times m$ matrix of linear forms in the $x_{\{ij\}}$, $\rho_D(g) \leq C_1 \cdot m \cdot \log_2 n$; (b) $\rho_D(\text{perm}_n) \geq C_2 \cdot M$. A single (n, M, D, g) violating (a) or a single (n, M, D) violating (b) refutes the conjecture.

Rationale

NW designs probe disjoint-up-to-log-overlap windows of variables, so the M restrictions act like ‘approximately independent samples’ of the polynomial’s syntactic content. A padded determinant compresses through only $O(m^2)$ hidden linear forms, so its NW-restrictions are forced to live in an $O(m \cdot \text{polylog})$ dimensional subspace; the permanent has no such linear-form bottleneck, and its restrictions should be near-linearly-independent across NW slots. Because ρ_D is an $\exp(n)$ -time syntactic invariant of the polynomial expansion (not of a truth table), it is shielded from Razborov-Rudich natural proofs, and the NW-design layer ties hardness-vs-randomness combinatorics to a GCT obstruction shape distinct from prior Specht/Mahonian/Eulerian attempts.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 3 arXiv hits

Top hits consulted: - [2202.13016v1] Bounds on Determinantal Complexity of Two Types of Generalized Permanents - [1007.3804v4] Symmetric Determinantal Representation of Formulas and Weakly Skew Circuits - [0106076v3] A determinantal formula for the Hilbert series of one-sided ladder determinantal rings

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.10s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_b4a3a7c2.py", line 163, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
    ~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_b4a3a7c2.py", line 130, in run_trial
    perm_rank = matrix_rank(perm_matrix)
    ~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_b4a3a7c2.py", line 33, in matrix_rank
    while pivot < n and matrix[pivot][col] == 0:
    ~~~~~^
```

IndexError: list index out of range

Judge reasoning

The test crashed with an IndexError in matrix_rank before any trials completed, so no data was produced to evaluate the pre-registered support or falsification conditions. | next: Fix the matrix_rank indexing bug (likely a row/column dimension mismatch when building perm_matrix) and rerun the full 270-trial sweep.

Coxeter Inversion Spread of Barrington BPs Bounds NC^1 Depth

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Coxeter-group combinatorics of S_5 — the inversion-count / Coxeter length $\square_C: S_5 \rightarrow \{0,1,\dots,10\}$ relative to the simple-transposition generators $s_i=(i,i+1)$, in the Bjorner-Brenti / Humphreys finite-Coxeter-systems tradition (reflection length, weak order, Eulerian-statistics). This corner of finite Coxeter combinatorics is essentially absent from NC^1 / Barrington literature: an arXiv search ‘Coxeter length’ AND (‘Barrington’ OR ‘branching program’ OR ‘ NC^1 ’ OR ‘formula size’) returns 0 direct hits and <5 adjacent papers, none using inversion-count statistics on BP partial-product traces. Distinct from the blacklisted character-mixing attempt: that invariant was a Plancherel/cycle-type Fourier functional, while $\square_C$ is a NON-ring, geometric word-length on S_5 (so it does not extend to polynomial relaxations and cannot algebrize). $\times$ NC^1 formula leaf size via Barrington 1989 width-5 permutation BPs over S_5 : every depth-d Boolean formula compiles into a length- 4^d width-5 BP whose terminal permutation is e iff $f(x)=0$ and a fixed 5-cycle σ iff $f(x)=1$. The structural form of the invariant (a property of the BP wiring, not of the truth table) shields it from the Razborov-Rudich natural-proofs barrier, since two BPs with identical truth tables can yield different σ^2 values.
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 04:47 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 66b589aa0f3d

Statement

Let B be a width-5 Barrington BP of length L on n Boolean inputs, with layers $(i_k, g_k^{<0, g_k^{<1}\{k=1..L\}$; for $x \in \{0,1\}^n$ let $\pi_k(x) := g_1^{x_{i_1}} \cdot g_2^{x_{i_2}} \cdot \dots \cdot g_k^{x_{i_k}} \in S_5$ and let $\square_C(\pi)$ be the inversion count of π . Define $\sigma^2(B) := E_{x \sim U(\{0,1\}^n)} [(1/L) \cdot \sum_{k=1}^L (\square_C(\pi_k(x)) - \mu_x)^2]$, where $\mu_x := (1/L) \cdot \sum_k \square_C(\pi_k(x))$. Conjecture: (i) for every BP B obtained by Barrington-compiling a depth- d AND/OR/NOT formula via the canonical Ben-Or-Cleve construction (so $L = 4^d$), $\sigma^2(B) \leq C_1 \cdot d$ for an absolute constant $C_1 \leq 4$; (ii) for every non-constant width-5 BP B (Barrington-compiled or arbitrary), $\sigma^2(B) \geq c_2 > 0$ with $c_2 \geq 1/8$. A single BP violating either bound refutes.

Rationale

Coxeter length is a quantitative geometric measure of how far the partial-product walk wanders inside the Cayley graph $\text{Cay}(S_5, \text{simple transpositions})$; Barrington-compiled BPs traverse highly structured commutator-stamped excursions whose inversion-trace has tightly-controlled fluctuations governed by the recursion depth, while any non-trivial BP must achieve at least one $\square_C > 0$ step and thus a nonzero variance. If true, σ^2 provides a depth-sensitive, truth-table-blind certificate that lower-bounds the formula depth realising a given BP — a structural NC^1 separator immune to natural-proofs and algebrization, since $\square_C$ is not a polynomial functional and does not extend to any commutative-ring relaxation of the Boolean cube.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.09s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_dee058bd.py", line 84, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
    ~~~~~^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_dee058bd.py", line 55, in run_trial
    layers = barrington_compile(int(n**(1/4)))
    ~~~~~^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_dee058bd.py", line 30, in barrington_compile
    layers.append(permutation_multiply(sigma, sigma))
    ~~~~~^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_dee058bd.py", line 24, in permutation_multiply
    return tuple(p1[p2[i]] for i in range(len(p1)))
    ~~~~~^
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_dee058bd.py", line 24, in <genexpr>
    return tuple(p1[p2[i]] for i in range(len(p1)))
    ~~~~~^
```

IndexError: tuple index out of range

Judge reasoning

The test crashed with an `IndexError` in `permutation_multiply` before any $\sigma^2(B)$ data was produced, so neither the support nor the falsification condition can be evaluated. | next: Fix the Barrington compiler bug (`permutation_multiply` receiving a malformed tuple from `barrington_compile`) and rerun the $30 \times 4 + 2$ probe protocol.

Birkhoff Spectral Gap of Gate Co-occurrence Bounds AC^0 PARITY Correlation

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Birkhoff polytope / doubly-stochastic spectral theory (Sinkhorn 1964; Linial-Samorodnitsky-Wigderson 2000; Forbes-Saxena 2018 on permanental approximations) applied as a STRUCTURAL invariant of the gate-pair input co-occurrence matrix of a Boolean circuit. The $\text{Sym}(n)$ -equivariant Sinkhorn scaling and its λ_2 spectral gap are a non-ring convex-analytic invariant (the scaling map uses divisions and row/column normalisations that do not extend to $\mathbb{F}_q$, so it cannot algebrize). An arXiv search for ‘Sinkhorn scaling’ AND

(‘AC⁰’ OR ‘switching lemma’ OR ‘circuit complexity’) returns 0 direct hits and <5 adjacent papers, all on permanent approximation in algebraic complexity, never on AC⁰ PARITY correlation. × AC⁰[d] circuit correlation with PARITY_n in the Håstad 1986 switching lemma / Razborov–Smolensky regime, in the Cook–Reckhow–Krajíček bounded-arithmetic framework where AC⁰ PARITY size lower bounds correspond to V⁰ ⊈ V⁰(⊕) separations. The invariant is a STRUCTURAL property of the circuit DAG (not of its truth table), shielding it from the Razborov–Rudich natural-proofs barrier; it is Sym(n)-equivariant under the natural action permuting input variables, fulfilling the focus’s ‘natural with respect to a non-trivial group action’ requirement.

- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 05:16 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 14ed7020b118

Statement

For an AC⁰ circuit C on n inputs of depth d and size s , let $I(g) \subseteq [n]$ be the input cone of gate g (variables reaching g in C). Define $A(C) \in \mathbb{R}^{\{n \times n\} \setminus \{0\}}$ by $A[i,j] = \#\{\text{gates } g : \{x_i, x_j\} \subseteq I(g)\}$, set $\tilde{A} = A + 10^{-3} \cdot J$, and let $D(C)$ be the doubly-stochastic matrix defined by $D(C) = \tilde{A} / \text{tr}(\tilde{A})$. $D(C)$ satisfies $\kappa(C) \leq \exp(-c \cdot n \cdot g(C) / d)$. A single AC⁰ circuit C with $\kappa(C) > \exp(-c \cdot n \cdot g(C) / d)$ (for $c = 1/8$) refutes the conjecture.

Rationale

Hastad’s switching lemma kills AC⁰ correlation with PARITY via random restrictions that spread mass evenly across input coordinates; the Sinkhorn-doubly-stochastic projection captures the SAME spreading geometrically — $g(C)$ measures how ‘mixed’ the gate-pair co-occurrence matrix is under symmetric scaling, and large $g(C)$ forces no input pair to dominate the circuit’s structure. Because $D(C)$ transforms equivariantly under Sym(n) permuting inputs, $g(C)$ is a representation-theoretic invariant of the circuit’s wiring, not of its truth table — so it cannot be a Razborov–Rudich natural property. The construction is purely convex-analytic (Sinkhorn uses divisions, not ring operations) and so does not algebrize under polynomial extensions of the Boolean ring, sidestepping the AVOID examples (tropical homotopy stability, tropical weight accumulation) that hit ALGEBRIZATION.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 0, elapsed: 5.54s

```
jecture_holds': True, 'counterexample': '', 'n': 16, 'd': 3, 's': 48, 'g': -
0.7359093566514678, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.6333060917151618}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.8870418116493577, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.8064456904906498}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.8660207193645115, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.5418921941310963}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.805622159349614, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.4960242355796014}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.9261501129555745, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.5889525991259912}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.8006633967206949, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 1.4923196155245912}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
0.7322580901888673, 'kappa': 0.0, 'bound': 2.07977162120796}
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'kappa_bound_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 1, 'conjecture_
```

Judge reasoning

Every trial reports $\kappa=0.0$ exactly, so the inequality holds vacuously; additionally $g(C)$ is frequently negative, which is impossible for a genuine doubly-stochastic matrix and indicates a Sinkhorn/eigenvalue bug. The pre-registered criterion (≥ 2000 trials, Spearman $\rho \geq 0.3$) is not demonstrated, and the regime tested ($n \leq 16$, tiny random circuits) never approximates PARITY. | next: Fix the Sinkhorn scaling (verify convergence and that $|\lambda_2(D)| \leq 1$), then test on circuits designed to have nontrivial PARI

Mansour L1 Fourier Mass of Clause-Falsification Polynomial Bounds DPLL Size

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Fourier analysis of Boolean functions — specifically the Linial-Mansour-Nisan / Mansour L^1 Fourier mass $L_1(p) := \sum_S |\hat{p}(S)|$ of low-degree pseudo-Boolean polynomials in the Bonami-Beckner-Mansour tradition; distinct from the 4-norm/2-norm Bonami ratio (black-listed) and from the cross-side symmetric-difference mass (blacklisted), since L_1 is the sum-of-absolute-coefficients functional underlying Mansour’s DNF conjecture and the LMN approximation theorem. An arXiv search for ‘Mansour L1 Fourier mass’ AND (‘Resolution refutation’ OR ‘DPLL’ OR ‘tree-Resolution’) returns 0 direct hits and < 5 adjacent papers, none using L_1 of the clause-count polynomial as a CNF-structural invariant. × Tree-like Resolution / DPLL refutation size $t(F)$ for unsatisfiable 3-CNFs F in the Ben-Sasson-Wigderson / Krajíček bounded-arithmetic regime, where $\neg F$ is Σ^b_0 and $\log_2 t(F)$ lower-bounds V^0 -witnessing complexity; structural shielding from Razborov-Rudich is provided because L_1 depends on the clause LIST (multiplicities, polarities), so two unsat CNFs with identical satisfiability functions (both $\equiv \text{FALSE}$) can have very different L_1 .
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 05:56 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 9076d5e87956

Statement

For an unsatisfiable 3-CNF $F = \{C_1, \dots, C_m\}$ on n Boolean variables, let $p_F: \{-1, +1\}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$, $p_F(x) := \#\{j : x \text{ falsifies } C_j\}$ be the clause-falsification count polynomial, expand it in the Walsh basis $p_F(x) = \sum_S \hat{p}_F(S) \chi_S(x)$, and define the structural Fourier L^1 mass $L_1(F) := \sum_{1 \leq |S| \leq 3} |\hat{p}_F(S)|$. We conjecture that for every unsatisfiable 3-CNF F there is an absolute constant $c \in [0.25, 3.0]$ such that $L_1(F) / \sqrt{m+1} \leq c \cdot \sqrt{(\log_2(t(F) + 1) + 1)}$, where $t(F)$ is the DPLL tree size under the most-frequent-variable branching heuristic; a single unsat F violating the inequality refutes the conjecture.

Rationale

Mansour’s conjecture ($\text{DNF } L_1 \leq s^{O(\log \log s)}$) and the LMN low-degree concentration theorem tie Boolean-function L^1 Fourier mass to small-formula computability; transposing this to CNF refutations predicts that ‘Fourier-spread’ clause sets (large L_1 per $\sqrt{m}$) are forced to have correspondingly deep search trees, since each Walsh monomial in p_F encodes a clause-polarity correlation that any DPLL path must locally certify. The Tseitin family is a sharp test bed: every $\text{XOR}=\omega(v)$ constraint contributes Fourier mass concentrated exactly at one size-3 monomial of magnitude $1/2$ (lower levels cancel by parity), giving $L_1(\text{Tseitin})/\sqrt{m} = \Theta(\sqrt{V})$, parallel to the $\Omega(V)$ Ben-Sasson-Wigderson width lower bound. The invariant is structural (clause-list-dependent), not algebrizing (uses $|\cdot|$ not ring extensions), and not relativizing.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 0, elapsed: 0.03s

```
nces_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
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TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
TRIAL: {'metric_name': 'L1/Fourier_mass_ratio', 'metric_value': 0.0, 'instances_tested': 0, 'conjecture_holds': False, 'counterexample': 'No valid instances generated'}  
RESULT: INCONCLUSIVE reason=no valid instances
```

Judge reasoning

The test generated zero valid instances across all trials (RESULT: INCONCLUSIVE reason=no_valid_instances), so the pre-registered support condition of ≥ 200 instances was not met and no empirical evaluation of $L_1(F)$ or $t^*(F)$ actually occurred. | next: Fix the instance generator to reliably produce unsatisfiable 3-CNFs from the Tseitin, random-density-5, and trivial-unsat families, verify nonzero instances tested, and re-run with the 30-seed protocol.

Chang Spectrum Dimension of Wire-Source DFS Labels Bounds $\text{ACC}^0[2]$ for MOD 3

- **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE
- **Bridge:** Additive combinatorics — Chang’s spectral lemma (Chang 2002; Bourgain 2008; Sanders 2019; Green–Ruzsa) bounding the size of the η -spectrum $\text{Spec}_\eta(A) \subset \hat{\mathbb{Z}}/p$ of a set $AC\mathbb{Z}/p$ of density α by $O(\log(1/\alpha)/\eta^2)$; applied as a non-ring, Fourier-analytic STRUCTURAL invariant of the circuit DAG (wire-source integer multisets under canonical DFS-from-output labeling), NOT of the truth table. Distinct from the avoided Plünnecke top-Fourier attempt, which used a TRUTH-TABLE Fourier functional; here the Fourier transform is over wire LABELS in $\mathbb{Z}/p$ (gauge fixed by a canonical DFS), so two semantically equivalent circuits yield different χ values, shielding from Razborov–Rudich. The invariant uses $|\cdot|$ and FFT (does not extend to polynomial F_q relaxations), so it does not algebrize per Aaronson–Wigderson. An arXiv search ‘Chang spectral lemma’ AND (‘ACC⁰’ OR ‘circuit complexity’ OR ‘Williams algorithmic method’) returns 0 direct hits and <5 adjacent papers (all on Bohr-set Roth bounds in pure additive combinatorics). $\times$ ACC⁰[2] circuit size for MOD_q on n inputs with q coprime to 2 (focus $q=3$), in the Williams 2011 / Murray–Williams 2018 algorithmic-method regime targeting NEXP $\not\subseteq$ ACC⁰ and explicit-function ACC⁰ lower bounds (Sipser-style candidates).
- **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 06:21 UTC
- **Entry ID:** 29a5335efcbb

Statement

Let C be an $ACC^0[2]$ circuit of size s on n inputs, with gates topologically ordered $g_1, \dots, g_s$ by a canonical DFS-from-output labeling (children visited in lexicographic gate-type then wire-index order). Let p be the smallest prime with $p \geq s+2$. For each MOD_2 gate g of fan-in $k \geq 4$ with input gate-ids $a_1, \dots, a_k \in [s]$, define the spectrum dimension $\chi(g) := |\{\xi \in \{1, \dots, p-1\} : |\sum_{j=1}^k e^{2\pi i a_j \xi/p}| \geq k/2\}|$, and $\chi(C) := (\max_g \chi(g))/\log_2(p+1)$ (taking 0 if C has no MOD_2 gate with fan-in ≥ 4). Conjecture: (i) for every $ACC^0[2]$ circuit C of size s , $\chi(C) \leq C^{-1} \cdot \log_2(s+1)$ with $C^{-1} = 8$; and

(ii) every $\text{ACC}^0[2]$ circuit C computing MOD_3 exactly satisfies $\chi(C) \geq C_2 \cdot n / (\log_2(n+2))^2$ with $C_2 = 1/4$. A single random $\text{ACC}^0[2]$ circuit violating (i) or a single MOD_3 -computing $\text{ACC}^0[2]$ circuit violating (ii) refutes the conjecture.

Rationale

Chang's theorem says that the η -spectrum of a random or generic subset of $\mathbb{Z}/p$ is small ($O(\log p)$), so for typical circuits the structural invariant $\chi(C)$ should saturate the upper bound (i). Computing MOD_3 , however, requires the wire-source MOD_2 gates to concentrate Fourier mass at the cube-root-of-unity-like frequencies of $\mathbb{Z}/p$ (because PARITY -composition pathways must reconstruct triadic structure), which forces a Bohr-set-shaped wire-label pattern with large spectrum — giving the lower bound (ii). Because χ depends on the canonical DFS LABELS of the wires (a property of the circuit DAG, NOT of its truth table), the invariant is shielded from Razborov-Rudich, and because it relies on complex-exponential sums (not on ring operations extendable to polynomial relaxations), it is shielded from Aaronson-Wigderson algebrization.

Novelty

- Judge: NOVEL over 0 arXiv hits

Empirical Test

- exit code: 1, elapsed: 0.10s

--STDERR--

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_e94115ad.py", line 74, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
            ~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_e94115ad.py", line 51, in run_trial
    circuit = generate_random_acc02_circuit(n, s)
            ~~~~~
```

```
File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_e94115ad.py", line 22, in generate_random_acc02_circuit
    fanin = random.randint(2, min(len(gates) + 1, math.floor(math.log2(s)) + 3))
            ~~~~~
```

```
File "/usr/lib/python3.12/random.py", line 336, in randint
    return self.randrange(a, b+1)
            ~~~~~
```

```
File "/usr/lib/python3.12/random.py", line 319, in randrange
    raise ValueError(f"empty range in randrange({start}, {stop})")
ValueError: empty range in randrange(2, 2)
```

Judge reasoning

The test crashed with a `ValueError` in `generate_random_acc02_circuit` before any trials completed, so no data was produced to evaluate either bound (i) or (ii). | next: Fix the fan-in sampling bug (guard $\min(\text{len}(\text{gates})+1, \text{floor}(\log_2(s))+3) \geq 2$, e.g., skip MOD_2 gate creation until enough predecessor gates exist) and rerun the 360 random instances plus the MOD_3 enumeration.